

CBS artist Joe Alvares and the Indian All stars; Girish and the Chronicles

MUSIC ▼

Songs for a Suburb

A new music festival in Mumbai aims to take the neighbourhood of Bandra back in time

Rock music fans bemoaning that they won't be able to get their fix of classics at Mumbai's annual Independence Rock (I-Rock) festival, which won't take place this year, have an alternative in the form of the Olly Fest. Long-running band Indus Creed, one of the mainstays of I-Rock, will play the inaugural edition of Olly Fest, held from November 14-16 at the amphitheatre of the 17th-century Bandra Fort.

The idea behind Olly Fest—christened after the nickname of its founder, events organiser Allwyn Saldanha—is to recreate the feeling Bandraites experienced in earlier decades when instead of the cacophony of construction work and traffic, "you used to hear music blasting out from people's houses".

The line-up comprises acts that specialise in genres that were being played in those homes: a mix of classic rock from the likes of veteran singer-songwriters Gary Lawyer and Joe Alvares; jazz and jazz-fusion from guitarist Sanjay Divecha and vocalist Vasundhara Vee's band Merkaba, the Sonia Saigal-led The S-Experience, and the Isheeta Chakravarty Collective; and pop covers by the groups Black In White and Shannon and the Silent Riot.

Lawyer will deliver a set dedicated to The Doors, while the Retro Legendary Act will play a tribute to Pink Floyd. Indus Creed will headline on Saturday, and hard rock and heavy metal heroes Girish and the Chronicles—who recently reached the quarter-finals of *America's Got Talent*'s twentieth season—will close on Sunday.

Saldanha says he's sure that attendees "will go home with a good vibe of what Bandra was like originally". The former merchant navy captain also plans to stage festivals of jazz and blues music as well as stand-alone concerts by more contemporary rock bands, at outdoor venues in the suburb, over the next two years. ■

THE LINE-UP HAS GENRES FAMILIAR TO OLD BANDRA, PLAYING CLASSIC ROCK, JAZZ, POP AND HEAVY METAL

—Amit Gurbaxani

Tickets for Olly Fest are being sold on BookMyShow.com

sarod and flute; acts in theatre; writes short stories, plays, poems; starts a magazine; loves Buñuel and Fellini; teaches; and writes on film theory. There are loving letters to his wife; a nascent film idea about Vietnam; a play produced with the inmates of the asylum in which he was institutionalised; Eisenstein declared the Kalidas of cinema, Bergman a fake, and Ray a giraffe whose films must be seen! A real, living Ghatak emerges for the English-speaking readers in all his volatile and exasperating glory.

So associated is Ghatak with his sense of failure that it is a joy to see him live, albeit in his own frenetic way: loving, abusing, defending melodrama, reciting *King Lear*, trying out unconventional sounds from musical instruments at 3:30 am, breaking film convention by jumping from long shot to extreme close up, glad after getting the famous last shot of *Jukti*... having poured country liquor on the lens. The book details his filmmaking—especially the main films—well, from their all-important sound design to the lighting, use of lenses and directing of actors, and a lovely essay on plants in his cinema. ■

—Juhi Saklani

The book features *loving letters to his wife, nascent film ideas and untimely musical experiments*—a frenetic artist's life